

the potential to impact everyone's life and I had the chance here to exploit my potential to the fullest." He went on to exploit his potential to the fullest for the agriculture sector right to the last man. His aptitude for exploring, integrating and introducing modern technology in agriculture has paid incredible dividends propelling the agriculture sector from the 'Green Revolution' towards 'Ever Green Revolution'!

An authority in the global fertiliser sector, among Dr Awasthi's remarkable lifetime contributions to the fields of fertilisers and agriculture are his path-breaking ideas that could potentially transform the agricultural scenario both in India and the world. They are namely the introduction of nanofertiliser, use of drone technology to effectively deliver nanofertiliser and ensure crop health monitoring, besides launching of Nano model village scheme to promote precision farming. From his innovative approach and outlook the farming community has gained immense confidence, in the use of modern tools, and reaped benefits from healthy crops. Today, even farmers in the US, who have adopted his pioneering nanotechnology in their farming, swear by the successful yield it has given them.

A multi-faceted titan of his field, Dr Awasthi, has expanded IFFCO into various businesses, diversified its operations, and has played a significant role in successfully developing indigenous Nano Fertilisers for Indian farmers. Among his innovative foresights is adopting Nanotechnology for Agriculture which clearly envisions the urgent need for cost effective, eco-friendly alternative to the conventional Urea, DAP and other bulk fertiliser that are applied to the soil indiscriminately. Pursuing his passion for innovation, he was instrumental in setting up Nano Biotechnology Research Centre (NBRC) in the Kalol unit and IFFCO Nanoventions, Coimbatore that are the research and product development arms of IFFCO.

Even as environmentalists waged relentless campaigns against the harmful impact of chemical fertilisers and pushed for sustainable farming practises, as head of IFFCO, which is one among the largest manufacturers of fertilisers, Dr. Awasthi,



was pivotal in minimizing the use of chemical fertilisers in agriculture through alternate technologies. This desire for sustainability in agriculture, propelled him to introduce nanofertilisers for the benefit of farmers and the environment, which needs special mention and appreciation.

Nanotechnology has huge potential in transforming many sectors by making atomic level alterations in the production processes. But, it is not easy to introduce such high tech and skilful alterations in fertiliser and agricultural sectors as it entails exorbitant capital expenditure and subsequent demanding operational and maintenance tasks. The agriculture sector owes it to Dr. Awasthi, whose perseverance, dedicated efforts and strategic decisions made the tough task a reality and he successfully introduced a spectrum of nano fertilisers in Indian agriculture that include Nano urea, Nano urea plus, Nano DAP, Nano Zinc and Nano copper. The objective of his innovative

journey was aimed at significantly reducing the usage of chemical fertilisers and inputs in agriculture through nanofertilisers that record highest nutrient use efficiency by the virtue of more reactive atoms available for reaction.

An agrarian nation, about 65-70 percent of India's population is involved directly or indirectly with the agriculture sector, which is the biggest revenue grosser. Ensuring its healthy growth in the sector is the key to a strong economy. Compassionate about farmers' welfare, Dr. Awasthi, applied his extensive experience in fertiliser industry and the knowledge of the ethos of India's farming systems inspiring him to ensure that this cutting edge nanofertiliser technology is available to farmers at a reasonable cost. In spite of the cost intricacies due to subsidy of fertilisers, including urea, in India, Dr. Awasthi, pegged nanofertilisers at a price that is affordable and profitable to sell. IFFCO launched Nanofertiliser in 2021 as a pioneer in this space and